

Texas Doughnut

Oversized yeast-raised — Shipley's / Cambodian-shop lineage · tall, cottony-light crumb · crackle-set glaze in four finishes

YIELD	FLOUR	HYDRATION	FRY
~10 @ 6" + holes	Sir Lancelot 14.2%	~58% eff.	350°F / 177°C

FORMULA — BAKER'S PERCENTAGES

Flour = 100% · scale to any flour weight

Bread flour — Sir Lancelot / Shepherd's Grain Opus (~14%); strength to tower the jumbo ring through proof	100%	1000 g
Whole milk — hydration + tenderness; hold a little back, add to feel	52%	520 g
Whole egg — 3 large; structure, lift, color	15%	150 g
Butter, softened — tender crumb, shelf life	12%	120 g
Granulated sugar — yeast food + Maillard browning	12%	120 g
Instant yeast — capped at 2%; more risks over-proof collapse at this size	2%	20 g
Kosher salt (by weight) — yeast regulation, flavor, gluten tightening	1.5%	15 g
Vanilla extract — flavor	1%	10 g

GLAZE BASE

Classic vanilla · crackle-set shellac

Powdered sugar	250 g
Whole milk	50 g
Light corn syrup / glucose	20 g
Vanilla to taste	—
Kosher salt pinch	—

Warm to ~40°C, dip warm doughnuts, drip on a rack. The corn syrup is what gives the thin translucent crackle-set shellac.

DOUGH READ

Drive the dough, not the gram count

Finish by feel: soft, smooth, slightly tacky — **not slack**. Effective hydration is ~58% once the egg's water is counted. **Hi-gluten flour drinks more water** than the standard bread flour this style is usually written for, so at 52% milk the dough may feel stiff — add the last of the milk (and a splash beyond if needed) to reach the soft-tacky finish. An enriched dough must be **fully developed** or it won't tower.

GLAZE VARIATIONS

One base — divide & augment to a thin ribbon

Make the base, divide into bowls, stir in the add-in, then correct each back to a **thin ribbon that coats and crackle-sets** — a little more powdered sugar if it loosens, a few drops of liquid if it stiffens. Amounts are per full base batch; scale to the portion you're flavoring.

Chocolate	Sift in 40 g Dutch-process cocoa , then add ~30 g milk to re-loosen — cocoa drinks liquid, so thin it back to a ribbon. Dutch cocoa gives darker color and a smoother, less-acidic finish.
Strawberry	Stir in 25 g freeze-dried strawberry powder (blitz fine, sift the seeds out); splash of milk if stiff. Natural pink, no dye . Freeze-dried adds flavor + color but no water , so the crackle-set holds — skip fresh purée, it weeps and runs on a jumbo.
Lemon-Poppy	Add zest of 2 lemons + 8 g poppy seeds , and use fresh lemon juice in place of the milk for the liquid. The zest oil carries the aroma, the juice brings the acid bite, the poppy the crunch.

Execution

OIL	ROLL	FRY	BATCH
350°F / 177°C	½" (¾" taller)	~90 s / side	2–3 max

MIX · BULK · CUT

- Mix:** combine dries (flour, sugar, kosher salt, instant yeast) + egg, milk, vanilla → shaggy mass.
- Knead to near-windowpane BEFORE the butter.** The structure has to be there first.
- Add softened butter;** knead to smooth, elastic, slightly tacky. Finish by feel — hi-gluten flour may want a splash more milk.
- Bulk ferment** to doubled, ~1–1.5 h at room temp. **Or cold-retard overnight** — deeper flavor, firmer dough, cleaner cuts.
- Sheet** cold dough to ½" (¾" for more height).
- Cut 6" outer / 1.5" hole. Do NOT twist the cutter** — sealed edges won't rise.
- Transfer each ring to its own 6×6" parchment square.** The paper is the transfer tool.

PROOF · FRY · GLAZE

- Final proof, 45–60 min,** covered loosely. Done when puffy and light, and a gentle poke holds a **slow-filling** indent — it should not spring fully back.
- Heat oil** (canola / peanut / shortening) to **350°F / 177°C**. Deep pot, half-full max; clip a thermometer.
- Lower each doughnut on its parchment, proof-side down.** After ~5–10 s the paper releases — pull it with tongs and discard.
- Fry to deep golden, ONE flip:** ~90 s/side at ½" (~2 min/side at ¾"). **Watch the white equator belt, not the clock.**
- Drain** on a wire rack over a sheet. **Glaze warm** (formula, page 1).

Time = thickness, not diameter. A 6" ring and a 3" ring at the same thickness fry in the same window — the oil drives heat through the same ½" either way. Set time by how thick you rolled.

FRY & FIX

Fry by observation — root cause → correction

Oil temp drifts	Clip a thermometer, check every batch . Below 350°F → greasy; above ~365°F → outside darkens before the center cooks. Hold 350°F and let it recover between drops.
Greasy / oil-logged	Oil too cold or sagged between batches, or over-proofed (weak structure soaks oil). Hold 350°F; 2–3 doughnuts max so temp recovers.
Raw center, dark crust	Oil too hot. Drop the temp.
No white belt	Flipped more than once, oil too cold, or under-proofed. Flip ONCE at golden — color, not clock.
Dense, tight crumb	Under-proofed, or gluten under-developed. Proof to a slow-filling poke; develop to near-windowpane before the butter.
Collapsed after proof	Over-proofed — too much gas for the gluten to hold. The poke should fill back slowly , not vanish.
Glaze weeps / runs off	Doughnut too hot when glazed, or dough over-hydrated. Cool slightly before dipping.